

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The White House** raced to calm panicked tech executives over the weekend after Trump's changes to the H-1B employment visa plunged the program into chaos. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump said** that media executive Lachlan Murdoch and his father, Rupert Murdoch, could be joining the team investing in TikTok's U.S. operations. **A2**
- ◆ **The parent of Saks Fifth Avenue** is in talks to sell 49% of Bergdorf Goodman, the ultraluxury department store, for about \$1 billion. **B1**
- ◆ **The SEC's Investor Advisory Committee** approved recommendations for how best to expand access to private markets, including guardrails to protect less-sophisticated investors. **B9**
- ◆ **U.S. chip giant Nvidia** pledged the equivalent of \$2.71 billion to boost U.K. artificial-intelligence startups and speed up the creation of new jobs and businesses. **B3**
- ◆ **"Demon Slayer: Infinity Castle"** again led the weekend domestic box office with \$17.3 million in ticket sales, pushing its cumulative take to \$104.7 million in that market. **B2**
- ◆ **Tax and legal services** firm Andersen Group filed for an initial public offering with the SEC. **B3**
- ◆ **Workday is making** its biggest push yet into artificial-intelligence agents with the rollout of new bots, a collaboration with Microsoft and the acquisition of Sana, an AI firm focused on workplace tools. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **The U.K., Australia and Canada** said they formally recognize a Palestinian state, a significant shift in longstanding foreign policy among Western governments. **A1**
- ◆ **The upper echelon** of the Trump administration and the Republican Party memorialized Charlie Kirk, telling a packed stadium that the slain activist was a Christian and conservative martyr. **A1, A7**
- ◆ **Trump in a series of** weekend social-media posts all but ordered Attorney General Pam Bondi to prosecute his political opponents. **A5**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** canceled an annual government survey that since the mid-1990s has gathered data to measure food insecurity across the nation. **A4**
- ◆ **Trump's speech** Tuesday to the U.N. General Assembly will tout his assertion of unilateral U.S. power abroad to a global body where his administration has surrendered much of its once-leading role. **A18**
- ◆ **Two recent fatal accidents** involving Chinese-made air-bag parts have revived regulators' warnings about counterfeit components that can explode during a vehicle crash. **A3**
- ◆ **Air traffic at two** Dallas-area airports returned to normal over the weekend after a telecom equipment outage. **A2**
- ◆ **Philippine police** arrested 49 people suspected of attacking officers and blocking roads and bridges leading to the presidential palace in Manila. **A9**
- ◆ **Died: Bernie Parent**, 80, ice hockey Hall of Famer. **A2**

JOURNAL REPORT

Climate Technology: Act fast to use home-energy tax credits. **R1-8**

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Erika Kirk, the wife of slain activist Charlie Kirk, joined President Trump at Kirk's memorial Sunday in Glendale, Ariz.

At Memorial, Trump Lauds Kirk As Martyr to Conservative Cause

By JACK MORPHET AND ELIZA COLLINS

GLENDAL, Ariz.—The upper echelon of the Trump administration and the Republican Party memorialized Charlie Kirk on Sunday in a political and religious event with little modern parallel, telling a packed football stadium that the slain activist was a Christian and conservative martyr.

President Trump, cabinet

officials, right-wing pundits and Christian pastors eulogized Kirk during the hours-long service, which came nearly two weeks after the 31-year-old father of two was shot to death. His death ratcheted up political tensions across the country and heightened fears that American politics had entered a dangerous new era.

Trump called Kirk a “great American hero” and an evangelist and martyr for free-

dom. “His voice on Earth will echo through the generations,” Trump said. “He will live forever.”

The event alternated between political and religious messages delivered by conservative leaders and friends of Kirk. Tens of thousands of attendees sang along to Christian contemporary music and raised their hands in prayer. Volunteers asked new voters to register as Republicans, and top executives of Kirk's organ-

ization, Turning Point USA, recalled how Kirk built one of the most important conservative political organizations. The Kirk family lives in Arizona and his organization is based there.

Kirk's wife, Erika, fought back tears as she appeared on

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- ◆ **Erika Kirk vows central role at Turning Point USA..... A7**
- ◆ **Political violence's ideology now more muddled..... A7**

A Faithful Tibetan Outfoxes China

He escaped from police and crossed miles of wilderness to freedom

By NIHARIKA MANDHANA AND JOSH CHIN

Chinese Communist Party officials stepped up a recruitment drive in the Tibetan village of Larima in the fall of 2012, tempting residents with offers of new homes and free pantry staples.

There was a catch. To collect, villagers had to renounce Buddhism, give up their prayer beads, and swear to oppose the Dalai Lama.

For Tibetans, the religious leader is the embodiment of their faith. To Beijing, he is a dangerous separatist, an

enemy of the state.

Some took the handouts, feigning party loyalty—but not Phurba Tsering. He rejected the offer, settling instead for more modest gifts that went to all families. The gifts came with a poster depicting Mao Zedong and other past Chinese leaders. Families were told to hang the posters in their home as a sign of gratitude.

As a practical matter, Phurba could have used financial help. He had a wife and three young children, and he scratched out a livelihood digging for caterpillar fungus, a prized ingredient

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The World's Most Famous Bagpiper's Secret Is 'Free Bird'

Ally Crowley-Duncan, 29, is the new star of the ancient instrument

By ROBERT MCMILLAN

PITTSBURGH—Ally Crowley-Duncan strutted around the stage at the Pittsburgh Irish Festival like a rock star.

But forget the Stratocaster; she was wailing away on a red set of MacLellan bagpipes.

The crowd flew into a frenzy as the 29-year-old launched into a medley of tunes that included “Free Bird.” Her many covers of the 1973

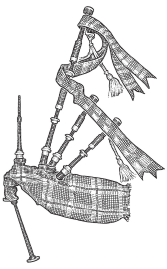
Lynyrd Skynyrd song have been viewed more than 100 million times on social media. “A quick show of hands. Who knows me from the internet?” she asked the audience.

About a third of those in front raised their hands.

“I’ve played ‘Free Bird’ and posted the live clip of it so many times,” Crowley-Duncan said earlier as she stood next to a droning diesel generator, partially covering her bagpipe’s finger holes to tune it. “Every time I post it, it goes viral.”

Long a feature of weddings, funerals and parades, and often played by kilted middle-aged men in starched shirts, the bagpipe has found a new generation of players. The revival of the ancient instrument began with the 1995 movie “Braveheart,” but it’s been su-

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Ready to rock

INSIDE



SPORTS
Standout Los Angeles Dodgers pitcher Clayton Kershaw is set to retire. **A14**



BUSINESS & FINANCE
A civil trial begins to determine if Amazon makes it too tough to leave Prime. **B1**

Big H-1B Visa Fees Spark a Scramble At U.S. Companies

The White House raced to calm panicked tech executives over the weekend after President Trump's changes to the popular H-1B visa plunged the program into chaos.

By Chip Cutter, Amrith Ramkumar and Ray A. Smith

The announcement on Friday that the administration planned to add a new \$100,000 annual fee for H-1B visa applications beginning at 12:01 a.m. ET Sunday caught companies and employees off guard, setting off a wave of anxiety and confusion.

Many feared they would have to pay the fee for existing H-1B holders trying to re-

turn to the country after that time.

Amazon, Alphabet's Google, Microsoft and others warned H-1B holders not to leave the country and urged employees overseas on the visa to return on Saturday because it could be difficult to re-enter, according to notes sent to staff reviewed by The Wall Street Journal and people familiar with their contents.

Companies worried they could be on the hook for enormous fee payments given how many of their employees use such visas.

Human-resources staffers divided up lists of workers and tried to determine employees' locations so they

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U.S. Investors Happy to Stay Cash Flush Despite Rate Cuts

By HANNAH ERIN LANG

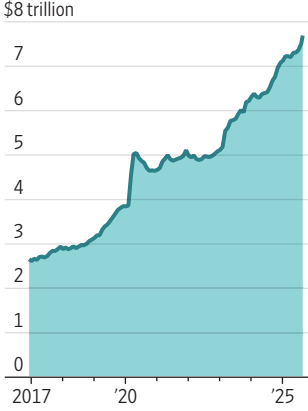
U.S. investors are sitting on a pile of cash. Even with interest rates now coming down, many are in no rush to move it.

Assets in money-market funds reached a record \$7.7 trillion this month, with more than \$60 billion flowing into those funds during the first four days of September, according to Crane Data, an industry researcher.

The latest rush into money funds began in 2022, when the Federal Reserve started raising rates. The yields on these funds, which typically hold short-term government debt, also rose, giving investors higher returns on their cash than they have had in years. Many have kept a larger slice of their portfolios in these cashlike investments ever since—as the stock market raced to records.

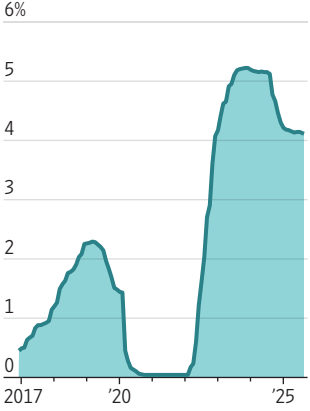
That is unlikely to change

Money-market funds assets*



*Figures as of Wednesday. †Based on the Crane 100 Money Fund Index. Source: Crane Data

Money-market yields†



soon, even with the Fed now cutting rates. Money funds are still yielding a lot more than what they had in the 2010s and early 2020s, when the financial crisis and then the Covid pandemic pushed rates

to ultralow levels. With stocks by some measures now more expensive than ever, some in-

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- ◆ **More safeguards urged for private-fund investors.... B9**